
T -SCALED REALIZATION OF p -ADIC HAHN SERIES

by

Yijun Yuan 

1. Preliminaries on Hahn series

To make this article self-contained, we briefly recall some basic facts about Hahn series.

Definition 1.1 ([Poo93, Section 3]). — Let R be a commutative ring and G be an ordered group.

1. For any $f \in \text{Hom}_{\text{Set}}(G, R)$, we define the **support** of f to be

$$\text{Supp}(f) = \{g \in G : f(g) \neq 0\}.$$

2. Define the set of **Hahn series** over R with value group G to be

$$R((G)) := \{f \in \text{Hom}_{\text{Set}}(G, R) : \text{Supp}(f) \text{ is well-ordered}\}.$$

By introducing a formal variable t , elements in $R((G))$ will also be written as $\sum_{g \in G} r_g t^g$, where $r_g \in R$ for all $g \in G$.

Proposition 1.2 ([Poo93, Lemma 1, Corollary 2]). — Let R be a commutative ring and G be an ordered group.

1. With identity $1 \cdot t^0$ and addition as well as multiplication given by

$$\sum_{g \in G} a_g t^g + \sum_{g \in G} b_g t^g := \sum_{g \in G} (a_g + b_g) t^g, \quad \sum_{g \in G} a_g t^g \cdot \sum_{g \in G} b_g t^g := \sum_{g \in G} \left(\sum_{h \in G} a_h b_{g-h} \right) t^g$$

$R((G))$ forms a commutative ring.

2. If R is a field, then so is $R((G))$. Moreover, with the map

$$v : R((G)) \longrightarrow G \cup \{\infty\}, \quad f \longmapsto \begin{cases} \min \text{Supp}(f), & \text{if } f \neq 0 \\ \infty, & \text{if } f = 0 \end{cases}$$

$R((G))$ becomes a valued field with value group G and residue field R .

Note that $\text{char } R((G)) = \text{char } R$, we call $R((G))$ the **equal-characteristic field of Hahn series** over R with value group G , also denoted as $R((t^G))$ with respect to the formal variable t .

Proposition 1.3 ([Poo93, Proposition 3, Corollary 3, Proposition 5])

Let k be a perfect field of characteristic p and G be an ordered group containing $\mathbb{Z}$ as a subgroup. Besides that, let

$$\mathcal{N} := \left\{ \sum_{g \in G} r_g t^g \in W(k)\langle\langle t^G \rangle\rangle : \text{for every } g \in G, \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} r_{g+n} p^n = 0 \right\},$$

where $W(k)$ is the ring of Witt vectors of k . We call elements in $\mathcal{N}$ the **null series** of $W(k)\langle\langle t^G \rangle\rangle$. Then

1. $\mathcal{N}$ is a maximal ideal of $W(k)\langle\langle t^G \rangle\rangle$, which makes $W(k)\langle\langle p^G \rangle\rangle := W(k)\langle\langle t^G \rangle\rangle / \mathcal{N}$ a field⁽¹⁾, called the **p -adic field of Hahn series**.
2. Every element in $W(k)\langle\langle p^G \rangle\rangle$ can be uniquely written as

$$\sum_{g \in G} [r_g] p^g,$$

where $r_g \in k$ for all $g \in G$ and $[\cdot]: k \rightarrow W(k)$ is the Teichmüller lift. We call this the **standard expansion** of the element.

3. For $f = \sum_{g \in G} [r_g] p^g$, define the **support** of f to be

$$\text{Supp}(f) = \{g \in G : r_g \neq 0\}.$$

Then the map

$$v: W(k)\langle\langle G \rangle\rangle / \mathcal{N} \rightarrow G \cup \{\infty\}, f \mapsto \begin{cases} \min \text{Supp}(f), & \text{if } f \neq 0 \\ \infty, & \text{if } f = 0 \end{cases}$$

makes $W(k)\langle\langle G \rangle\rangle / \mathcal{N}$ a mixed-characteristic valued field with value group G and residue field k .

The most important property of the field of Hahn series is the following:

Theorem 1.4 (cf. [Poo93, Theorem 1, Corollary 4, Corollary 6])

Let F be an equal-characteristic (resp. mixed-characteristic) valued field with divisible value group G and algebraically closed residue field k . Then the equal-characteristic (resp. p -adic) field of Hahn series $k\langle\langle t^G \rangle\rangle$ (resp. $W(k)\langle\langle p^G \rangle\rangle$) is the unique (up to isomorphisms of valued field) minimal spherically complete extension of F . Moreover, it is algebraically closed and complete.

The following examples are the fields of Hahn series used in this article:

Example 1.5. — Let $F = \overline{\mathbb{F}}_p\langle\langle t \rangle\rangle$ (resp. $\check{\mathbf{Q}}_p = W(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p)[p^{-1}]$), which has value group $\mathbf{Q}$ and residue field $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p$. Then the field of equal-characteristic (resp. p -adic) Hahn series $\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p\langle\langle t^{\mathbf{Q}} \rangle\rangle$ (resp. $\mathcal{O}_{\check{\mathbf{Q}}_p}\langle\langle p^{\mathbf{Q}} \rangle\rangle = W(\overline{\mathbb{F}}_p)\langle\langle p^{\mathbf{Q}} \rangle\rangle$) is the spherical completion of F with residue field and value group unchanged, which is algebraically closed and complete.

Remark 1.6. — To simplify the statement, we will simply call $\mathcal{O}_{\check{\mathbf{Q}}_p}\langle\langle p^{\mathbf{Q}} \rangle\rangle$ the p -adic Hahn series without specifying the residue field and value group.

2. T -scaled realization of $\mathbf{L}_p$

During this section, T will be an positive integer.

⁽¹⁾Intuitively speaking, $W(k)\langle\langle p^G \rangle\rangle$ is obtained by replacing the formal variable t of elements in $W(k)\langle\langle t^G \rangle\rangle$ by the prime p .

Lemma 2.1. — One has $\left[\check{\mathbf{Q}}_p(p^{1/T}) : \check{\mathbf{Q}}_p\right] = T$. In particular, $1, p^{1/T}, \dots, p^{(T-1)/T}$ form a basis of $\check{\mathbf{Q}}_p(p^{1/T})$ over $\check{\mathbf{Q}}_p$.

Proof. — Since $\check{\mathbf{Q}}_p$ is a discrete valuation field and $p^{1/T}$ is a root of the Eisenstein polynomial $X^T - p$, the result follows from the Eisenstein criterion. $\square$

Lemma 2.2. — Every element of $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]$ can be uniquely written as $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} [c_k] p^{\frac{k}{T}}$.

Proof. — This is a simple corollary of the fact that every element in $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)$ can be uniquely written as $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} [c_k] p^k$. The proof may also need Lemma 2.1. $\square$

Remark 2.3. — $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$ is a subfield of $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$ via the natural inclusion $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p) \subset W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]$.

Definition 2.4. — Let $\mathcal{N}_T$ be the set of elements $\sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} c_q t^q \in W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$ that for any $q \in \mathbf{Q}$,

$$\sum_{n \in \mathbf{Z}} c_{q + \frac{n}{T}} p^{\frac{n}{T}} = 0.$$

We call these elements the **T -null-series** in $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$.

Remark 2.5. — Obviously when $T=1$, $\mathcal{N}_T$ is the null-series in $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)((p^{\mathbf{Q}}))$ defined in Proposition 1.3.

Lemma 2.6. —

1. $\mathcal{N}_T$ is an ideal of $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$.
2. For every element f of $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$, there exists a unique element $g = \sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} [g(q)] t^q$ in $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$ such that $f - g \in \mathcal{N}_T$.
3. $\mathcal{N}_T$ is a maximal ideal of $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$, which makes $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))/\mathcal{N}_T$ a field.

Proof. — These three statements are generalizations of [Poo93, Proposition 3], [Poo93, Proposition 4] and [Poo93, Corollary 3] respectively, and the proofs are every similar. $\square$

Remark 2.7. — By (2) of this lemma, we will formally write elements of $W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))/\mathcal{N}_T$ as $\sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} [g(q)] p^q$.

Lemma 2.8. — One has $\mathcal{N}_T \cap W(\bar{\mathbf{F}}_p)((t^{\mathbf{Q}})) = \mathcal{N}$.

Proof. — Let $f = \sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} [f(q)] t^q \in \mathcal{N}$, then for any $q \in \mathbf{Q}$,

$$(a) \quad \sum_{n \in \mathbf{Z}} [f(q + n)] p^n = 0.$$

Notice that for any $q \in \mathbf{Q}$, one has

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{n \in \mathbf{Z}} \left[f\left(q + \frac{n}{T}\right) \right] p^{\frac{n}{T}} &= \sum_{u=0}^{T-1} \sum_{\substack{n \in \mathbf{Z} \\ n \equiv u \pmod{T}}} \left[f\left(q + \frac{n}{T}\right) \right] p^{\frac{n}{T}} \\ &= \sum_{u=0}^{T-1} p^{\frac{u}{T}} \sum_{n \in \mathbf{Z}} \left[f\left(q + \frac{u}{T} + n\right) \right] p^n. \end{aligned}$$

By applying (a) to $q + \frac{u}{T}$ for $u = 0, 1, \dots, T-1$, one has $\sum_{n \in \mathbf{Z}} [f(q + \frac{n}{T})] p^{\frac{n}{T}} = 0$. As a result, $f \in \mathcal{N}_T$.

Conversely, let $g = \sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} [g(q)]t^q \in \mathcal{N}_T$. Then for any $q \in \mathbf{Q}$, one has

$$\sum_{n \in \mathbf{Z}} \left[g\left(q + \frac{n}{T}\right) \right] p^{\frac{n}{T}} = \sum_{u=0}^{T-1} p^{\frac{u}{T}} \sum_{n \in \mathbf{Z}} \left[g\left(\left(q + \frac{u}{T}\right) + n\right) \right] p^n = 0.$$

By Lemma 2.1, for any $u = 0, 1, \dots, T-1$, one has $\sum_{n \in \mathbf{Z}} [g((q + \frac{u}{T}) + n)] p^n = 0$. The result follows from taking $u = 0$. $\square$

Lemma 2.9. — *One has $W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)((t^{\mathbf{Q}})) + \mathcal{N}_T = W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$.*

Proof. — Take $f = \sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} c_q T^q \in W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$, where

$$c_q = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} [c_{q,n}] p^{\frac{n}{T}} \in W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}].$$

Then one has $f = f_0 + p^{\frac{1}{T}} f_1 + \dots + p^{\frac{T-1}{T}} f_{T-1}$, where

$$f_u = \sum_{t \in \mathbf{Q}} \left(\sum_{\substack{n \in \mathbf{N} \\ n \equiv u \pmod{T}}} [c_{q,n}] p^{\frac{n-u}{T}} \right) t^q \in W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)((t^{\mathbf{Q}})), \quad u = 0, 1, \dots, T-1.$$

It suffices to show that $p^{\frac{u}{T}} f_u$ belongs to $W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)((t^{\mathbf{Q}})) + \mathcal{N}_T$ for $u = 0, 1, \dots, T-1$. This is clear if we write f_u as $f_u = (p^{\frac{u}{T}} \cdot t^0 - t^{\frac{u}{T}}) f_u + t^{\frac{u}{T}} f_u$, where $t^{\frac{u}{T}} f_u \in W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$ and $(p^{\frac{u}{T}} \cdot t^0 - t^{\frac{u}{T}}) f_u$ is a T -null-series. $\square$

Proposition 2.10. — *One has isomorphism of valued fields*

$$\sigma: \mathbf{L}_p \xrightarrow{\cong} W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))/\mathcal{N}_T.$$

Moreover, the following diagram commutes:

$$(b) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)((t^{\mathbf{Q}})) & \xhookrightarrow{\iota} & W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}})) \\ \downarrow \pi & & \downarrow \pi_T \\ \mathbf{L}_p & \xrightarrow[\sigma]{\cong} & W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))/\mathcal{N}_T \end{array}.$$

Proof. — This is the direct consequence of the following standard fact in commutative algebra: given domains $R_1 \subset R_2$ and an ideal I of R_2 , if $R_1 + I = R_2$, then $R_1/(I \cap R_1) \cong R_2/I$, where the isomorphism is induced by the inclusion $R_1 \subset R_2$. $\square$

Remark 2.11. — *For any element $f = \sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} [f(q)]p^q \in \mathbf{L}_p$, its lift $\widehat{f} = \sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} [f(q)]t^q \in W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$ embeds into $W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))$ and then can be projected to the element in $W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))/\mathcal{N}_T$, which can also be formally written as $\sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} [f(q)]p^q$. The commutative diagram in the above proposition above implies that the isomorphism between $\mathbf{L}_p$ and $W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))/\mathcal{N}_T$ is given by the formula*

$$\sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} [f(q)]p^q \in \mathbf{L}_p \longmapsto \sum_{q \in \mathbf{Q}} [f(q)]p^q \in W(\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p)[p^{1/T}]((t^{\mathbf{Q}}))/\mathcal{N}_T.$$

References

- [Poo93] B. Poonen. “Maximally Complete Fields”. In: *L’Enseignement Mathématique* 39.1-2 (1993), p. 87. DOI: 10/kqcb.

YIJUN YUAN[✉], Institute for Theoretical Sciences, Westlake University, No. 600 Duncun Road, Sandun town,
Xihu district, Hangzhou, Zhejiang Province, 310030, China • *E-mail* : 941201yuan@gmail.com
Url : <https://yijunyuanyuan.github.io/>